

Alan Soto

ENGINEERING MANAGER

DETAILS

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EDUCATION

Master of Project Management
Queensland University of Technology ·
Dean's Award, 7.0 GPA

Bachelor of Systems Engineering
Universidad de Lima

CERTIFICATIONS

AI Assisted Development with Claude
2026

AWS Cloud Practitioner
in progress, exam Aug 2026

LeanUX and Product Discovery for Agile Teams
2018

React Nanodegree
2017

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM)
2012

PMP (Project Management Professional)
2012

PROFILE

Engineering Manager with 15+ years of software delivery leadership across B2B SaaS, including direct domain expertise in global e-learning platforms. My focus is turning product roadmaps into reliable engineering execution while coaching teams to own their outcomes. I have operated across the entire scale spectrum, from hands-on people management of a squad at Go1, to coaching EMs and Tech Leads across 10+ teams at Xero on delivery rhythms, capacity, and operational reliability. Direct, hands-on experience helping engineering teams adopt effective AI-assisted development practices.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Xero Mar 2022 — Jul 2026
Lead Technical Program Manager
Brisbane (remote)

Xero is a global cloud accounting platform with roughly 4,500 employees. I led the API Program, a company-wide initiative to move every product capability onto a single federated API so that third parties and AI agents could reach them through one surface. Before that I led AI for Customers, a program embedding machine learning into products used by over 3 million small businesses and accounting practices, and a major payments platform integration for the US market.

CHALLENGE & IMPACT

- **Problem:** Xero needed to migrate dozens of autonomous engineering teams off a legacy API surface onto a federated platform without disrupting daily platform operations or customer experience.
- **Solution:** I led discovery to ship a thin vertical slice to production for a high-traffic team, proving the pattern and establishing the scale test. Using these insights, I partnered with engineering leads across all divisions to create a unified migration roadmap; complete with owners, target quarters, and statuses; which executives adopted as the official launch schedule.

KEY CONTRIBUTIONS

- Coached engineering managers and tech leads across 10+ teams on cycle time, capacity planning, forecasting, and healthy delivery rhythms, improving flow and predictability without owning their teams.
- Worked inside a division-wide CI/CD uplift: implemented observability tooling for DORA metrics, personally built the automated Lead Time for Changes dashboards, and facilitated the sessions that established SLOs, on-call practices, and progressive delivery.
- Reported program milestones, risks, trade-offs, and capacity to GM and executive-level leadership on a standing cadence.

Nagare (nagare.com.au)

2025 — Present

Personal Project

Brisbane

A small workshop of browser-based tools for delivery practitioners, built and shipped alongside my role at Xero using AI assisted development.

- Operating Rhythm Builder: A tool for designing a team's meeting cadences and delivery rhythms, turning the operating models I have built inside companies into something any team can set up for itself.
- Delivery Date Forecaster: samples a team's historical throughput and runs Monte Carlo simulations to forecast completion dates at different levels of confidence.
- The Map: an interactive guide to software-delivery knowledge, laid out like a city, for practitioners finding their way around the discipline.

Go1

Nov 2020 — Mar 2022

Technical Program Manager

Brisbane, QLD

Go1 is a global B2B e-learning SaaS platform. I joined during hyper-growth and led a cross-functional squad of eight: six engineers, a designer, and a product owner, taking end-to-end ownership of a new product enabling creators to optimise and distribute content across Go1's global learning network.

CHALLENGE & IMPACT

- **Problem:** The company was growing faster than its ways of working. Delivery was unpredictable, stakeholders had no reliable view of quality or timing, and the squad was absorbing constant organisational change.
- **Solution:** I established a common operating model from scratch - sprint practices, planning rhythms, backlog refinement, and delivery reporting - that lifted the pace of delivery and gave stakeholders confidence in both quality and predictability. It was adopted beyond my own squad.

KEY CONTRIBUTIONS

- Owned hiring, onboarding, coaching, performance, and team health through rapid organisational change, holding the behavioural bar while the company reshaped around us.
- Ran the full delivery lifecycle from discovery to production: scoped MVPs, made technical trade-offs, ran planning and refinement, coordinated releases.
- Ran an internal incubator with a designer, product manager, and commercial lead, validating ideas through mockups, prototypes, and technical spikes before committing engineering time.

Suncorp Group

Nov 2019 — Nov 2020

Delivery Coach

Brisbane, QLD

Suncorp is one of Australia's largest financial services and insurance groups. I was embedded in Data Engineering, running delivery for the replacement of the enterprise telephony and data platform across the entire organisation and all its affiliate brands.

CHALLENGE & IMPACT

- **Problem:** A compliance-critical legacy platform had to be retired across every brand in the group, coordinated across four engineering teams including offshore contractors, plus Infrastructure, Security, business units, and external vendors. There was no delivery governance in place when I arrived, and the program then ran straight into COVID-19 and a corporate restructure.
- **Solution:** I built the governance the program needed: dependency management, cross-team communication patterns, visual progress reporting, and delivery rhythms. The migration stayed on track through the disruption, and data risks were identified and escalated rather than discovered late.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY (CONTINUED)

KEY CONTRIBUTIONS

- Verified that technical solutions met data governance standards, identified data risks, and escalated them into the right forums.
- Mapped data lifecycles and system dependencies through user journeys, architectural diagrams, and story maps so teams and stakeholders shared one picture.
- Coordinated external vendors and offshore contractors as part of the delivery, keeping interfaces and handoffs reliable across organisational boundaries.

Virgin Australia

Jun 2019 — Nov 2019

Enterprise Agile Coach

Brisbane, QLD

Consulting engagement through Neu21, in the Ancillary Sales function

- Coached four product owners using a tell-show-do-review model until they were running their own standups, planning, and retrospectives without me.
- Led quarterly planning workshops with 70+ people across digital delivery, surfacing technical dependencies early.
- Established a single product backlog and physical Kanban boards giving end-to-end visibility of all work in flight across squads, and delivered measurable improvement in delivery performance across the products in scope.

intelliHR

Feb 2018 — Jun 2019

Head of Product

Brisbane, QLD

HR SaaS scale-up, roughly 20 developers. Acquired by Humanforce in 2023.

- Built the product management function from scratch and directly managed a team of five, establishing discovery rhythms, roadmapping, and prioritisation.
- Led the design and delivery of AI-powered people-analytics features using natural language processing, working alongside engineers and data scientists, with internal pilots run before external launch.
- Shifted the organisation from a feature factory to cross-functional squads owning end-to-end customer problems, and introduced behavioural analytics (Pendo, FullStory) to move decisions onto evidence.

Console Group / Reapit

Feb 2017 — Feb 2018

Iteration Manager

Brisbane, QLD

B2B real-estate management SaaS platform

- Led a cross-functional engineering team delivering a new payments capability, including a deep integration with an external payments provider, owning scope shaping, timelines, capacity planning, and release coordination through to production.
- Worked with architects, engineers, and the external partner to unblock technical issues early and keep the integration reliable and secure.
- Owned the team's engineering ways of working and coached product owners and designers through discovery, user story mapping, and prototype validation.

EARLIER

Projects Lead at 2sol Software Studios (2017). Owned end-to-end delivery of Flight Centre's online hotel and accommodation booking ecosystem, while directly managing a team of five developers. Systems Architect at Emedia Campaigns (2012), Designed high-availability ticketing, booking, and payment systems for major events including V8 Supercars, the Byron Bay Blues Festival, and Bridge to Brisbane.